

National Shrine of The Divine Mercy

2 Prospect Hill • Stockbridge, Massachusetts 01262
Tel. (413) 298-3931 • Fax (413) 298-3910 • E-mail shrine@marian.org



USCCB Requirement for Letters of Good Standing

Since August 2016, **we are required to receive the following Letters of good Standing (LGS) for all priests and deacons who are from outside the Diocese of Springfield, MA, by the Bishop of the Diocese of Springfield, MA**, when they are visiting The National Shrine of The Divine Mercy in Stockbridge, MA. Please note that the same requirements/format are to be used for Deacons and for Priests who visit The National Shrine of The Divine Mercy.

These Letters of Good Standing are necessary in order for the priests and deacons to perform their clerical duties while they are visiting.

We appreciate your assistance with us complying with the USCCB requirements to protect us all and all those who visit the Shrine.

Format and Address of the Letters

The Bishop's Chancery may copy you at the same time, but **we are to receive the letters directly from the Bishop.**

- They may send the letter:
 - **Attached** to an email to Pilgrims@Marian.org.
 - **Via snail mail to the address on this letterhead.**
 - Chanceries within the Province of the Archdiocese of Boston may use the internal system set up within the Province for this purpose
- **Note: This letter must be presented on official letterhead from the Bishop's Office or the Vicar of the Clergy with a seal.**
- Please note: We are **not** to accept:
 - Celebret cards.
 - Emails **unless** the email contains an attached document **on official letterhead from the Bishop's Office or the Vicar of the Clergy with a seal.**

What we Need

Please have the Bishop's Chancery send the letters directly to us at the address or email on this letterhead at least two weeks – a month in advance of your trip, but not more than three months in advance.

What is to be included in the letter:

The items required in the letter are:

1. The Priest or Deacon's Name;
2. The Diocese where he is currently residing;
3. His present position and address where he is serving.
4. Statements that he:
 - a. Is of good moral character;
 - b. Is free of any impediments;
 - c. Has participated in an adult training program for the Protection of Children and Young People
 - d. Is a priest or deacon of good standing
5. The date of his visit to The National Shrine;
6. His stated business.

In Christ,

Timothy Ryan
Pilgrim coordinator
The National Shrine of The Divine Mercy